

Rehearsal house for city theatre artistes near Bangla Academy

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THEATRE ARTISTES of the city have never had it so good. For long, theatre groups have had to hunt for quiet spaces to hold last minute rehearsals. But thanks to the department of information and cultural affairs, they can soon practise in peace at a "rehearsal house", to be set up by the Natya Academy. The proposed auditorium will come up on a 12-acre plot near Birji Talao, Bangla Academy.

"Space is the key. Community halls and corporation schools can't always come into the rescue act. Such a rehearsal house

is definitely welcome," says actress Usha Ganguly, who works for the Rangakarmee. Gyanesh Mukherjee agrees, "Bengal has always been a prominent cultural hub."

The department is also planning seminar halls and discussion rooms, which can be common meeting points for the city's intelligentsia.

There's good news for street artistes too. To meet their demands, an open-air podium will soon be erected in the city. Also in the pipeline is a Folk Village on the Eastern Bypass. A museum and an open-theatre are also in the agenda.

If you haven't yet experienced

the histrionics of jatra, you can soon, at a Jatra Mancha, being planned adjacent to the Girish Mancha in Bagbazar.

The Jatra Mancha would bring together urban and rural talents. With 50 per cent of the work already underway, the department is hoping to complete the construction of the hall soon.

Tapan Bandopadhyay, director of culture, said the bottlenecks to the construction of the Kolkata Lalbazar in New Market Square would soon be removed.

The auditorium was all set for a gala opening since there were no legal hurdles, Bandopadhyay added.